

ESSENTIAL

Document Checklist by Applicant Type

Employed - Self-Employed - Student - Retired

Every applicant needs

- Valid passport, and any expired passports showing prior travel history
 - DS-160 confirmation page (with the barcode)
 - Appointment confirmation letter
 - One recent photo meeting the official requirements (some posts also require this printed even though it's uploaded digitally - check your embassy's specific instructions)
 - MRV fee payment receipt
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If you're employed

- Employment verification / no-objection letter from your employer, stating your position, salary, start date, and approved leave dates for the trip
- Recent pay stubs (typically the last 3-6 months)
- Bank statements showing salary deposits and available balance
- Income tax filings or equivalent, if readily available

If you're self-employed or run a business

- Business registration / incorporation documents
- Recent business bank statements
- Tax returns for the business and/or personally
- A brief letter explaining who will manage operations while you travel

If you're a student

- Current enrollment verification letter from your school
- A letter confirming you're expected to continue your studies after the trip (from a registrar or academic office)
- If a parent or guardian is funding the trip: their financial documents plus a letter confirming their support and relationship to you

- If you are a minor traveling without both parents: a notarized consent letter from the non-traveling parent(s), where applicable

If you're retired

- Pension or retirement account statements
- Proof of property ownership, if applicable
- Documentation of family ties remaining at home (e.g. children, grandchildren) if relevant to your case

Don't over-pack the folder

Bring what's listed above, organized and easy to hand over - officers rarely review every document in detail given how short interviews typically are. A clear, well-organized folder reads as more credible than a stack of everything you could find.